



Nothing like inaugurating a FOSS event by squashing a Windoze XP balloon



Busy with the keyboards at one of the workshops



Yes, work smart and y'all shall be freed



Time to take freelunch, the 'shaadi wala khaana'

Day 3: Crunching the CPU

In the Web track, Vivek Khurana shared the nuts and bolts of Web database application development by introducing MySQL to the crowd. He gave a rapid-round recap of SQL and normal forms. Then he introduced a bit of PHP in the MySQL arena. He discussed the benefits of MySQL as a Web database and also helped his audience get a feel of it, hands on.

In the systems programming track, this was the day of the BOSS (Bharat Operating System Solutions) team from CDAC-NOIDA. Jai Bhaskar followed Mayank in an iterative hands-on GTK+ toolkit session, which mesmerised the participants. GUI programming in plain 'C' was an instant hit. Jai combined simple techniques effectively in small GTK+ programs. When the session was over, it was a new beginning for many. He discussed CDAC projects using GTK+ toolkit and inspired the hackers to play with it for a better future for the GUI on UNIX and UNIX-like systems.

P. Govind Raj is a Linux kernel hacker in the BOSS team. He specially prepared a session on 'The Linux Kernel from 30,000 feet', a practical kernel hacking introduction for newbies! His approach worked very well, and budding hackers had a warm feeling towards the kernel and its friends in the GNU system while the temperature outside emulated 'Dilli ki Sardi'.

Govind followed Mayank from the point of the 'syscall' interface in the Linux kernel. He demonstrated how to write a simple character driver and dynamically attach modules to the kernel. He also covered 'strace' and interfacing with 'proc' VFS. The next Indian contributor to the Linux kernel may be someone who attended this session—who knows!

The BOSS team also demonstrated the enhanced multi-lingual capabilities of the latest release, 3.0, of the BOSS distribution. BOSS now supports 18 Indian languages.

The FOSS student projects were discussed largely during the breaks and after the sessions. Sandeep Singh (HBTI Kanpur) was curious to write an open source DoS Defence Mechanism inside the kernel itself. Sumit Srivastava and Navneet Rastogi (IIMT Meerut) discussed enhancements of their LZW compressor and decompressor system developed using GTK+. Arun (MIET Meerut) was curious to leverage the potential of student projects in Web technologies.

Evening 3: Starting the journey

In the closing ceremony, the chairman of the IIMT group of colleges, Yogesh Mohanji Gupta, expressed gratitude towards the historic meeting of national hackers at IIMT Engineering College, Meerut. He also thanked *LFY* for becoming the media partner for FOSSTIVAL 2009, creating another milestone between GLUG-Meerut and *LFY*. All the participants were glad to receive the latest issue of *LFY*.

FOSSTIVAL 2009 was made possible by the collective efforts of Prof. O. N. Mehrotra (director, IIMT Engineering College), Mohit Singh (coordinator, GLUG-Meerut), Arun Singh, Nikhil Gupta, Anshu Sharma, Anjali Shrivastav and the GLUG-Meerut team of the Student Software Freedom Commandos. The FOSSTIVAL 2009 participants left IIMT with a promise to meet again next year in a larger event with a broader spectrum of technology and events. **END**

By: The GLUG-Meerut Commandos

The commandos helped organise everything from top to bottom and they were also the most enthusiastic participants of FOSSTIVAL sessions. Under the command of Mohit Singh, the GSOC (GLUG Student On-duty Commandos) team of young Software Freedom enthusiasts comprises of Sandeep Singh (HBTI, Kanpur), Sumit Srivastava, Navneet Rastogi, Nikhil Saxena, Fahad Tasleem, Shikha Singh, Farha Naaz, Harshi Gupta (All from IIMT, Meerut), Arun (MIET, Meerut) and many more soldiers of software freedom from all over India. GLUG-Meerut welcomes all software freedom supporters at groups.google.com/group/glug-meerut and is present on web as www.glug-meerut.org